cent. Together, these three gases contributed 97 per cent of GHGs. The remaining gases, basically those monitored under the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer, also called F-gases, contributed 3 per cent. CO_2 is primarily generated by burning of fossil fuels in the industrialization and transportation processes. Therefore, industrialization and transportation are the primary cause of GHG emissions, which in turn contribute to raising global temperatures and causing most of the ill-effects of climate change.

Global Priority is to Control GHG Emissions

While climate change is a complex phenomenon and a result of myriad forces (natural and human) working on the environment, the global community has been able to subsume the impact of all GHG emissions on global warming.

A reasonably steady relationship has been defined for the quantity of GHGs in the atmosphere in the pre-industrial period (1850–1900), the increase in this pre-industrial GHG inventory over a longish period of thirty years, and the total inventory of GHGs at which average global temperatures will rise by a specified percentage.

Experts believe incalculable damage would be done to the earth and its residents if temperatures were to rise by more than 2 per cent over the pre-industrial average. The world can avoid the most pernicious consequences if it can limit the global temperature rise in the twenty-first century well below 2° Celsius above pre-industrial levels and further pursue concerted efforts to limit the temperature increase to 1.5° Celsius.

Global consciousness, which started emerging in the 1960s, saw its first manifestation at the Earth Summit in Rio in 1992 to commit to an agenda for the twenty-first century: Agenda 21. Finally, global concern transformed into global resolve in the form of the Paris Agreement in 2015.